

Asttecs launches IP PBX solution for educational institutions

Open source communication solutions provider, Asttecs, has launched its IP PBX advanced telecom solution for educational institutions. The new offering provides an integrated telephony support with tailored applications to enable schools, colleges, hostels and universities communicate using the power of open source.

Unlike a traditional telecom model, the new Asttecs IP PBX solution comes preloaded with features like paging, Web-based video conferencing and voice blasting. It also gives the smartphone as an extension service using an active Wi-Fi network.

“Our IP PBX solution for educational institutions is designed to deliver powerful communication tools and operational applications that simplify the daily tasks of faculty and students,” said Manjunath R.J., head of the IP PBX division at Asttecs, in a statement.

Based on open standards-based architecture, the new solution offers intelligent call routing and IVR functionality to ease communication between students, teachers and other staff. It also provides real-time connectivity between teaching staff through Wi-Fi extensions, directory services and smartphone integration. Besides, there are options such as voice blast and paging, multi-party audio and video conferencing, emergency alerts, appointment scheduling and reminders, among others.

For students, Asttecs has given a complete call management suite that includes time-based calling slots, inbound and outbound calling, and call duration control, black list and white list support, user ID and password powered calling, the prepaid and postpaid calling facility and billing details.

“Effective communication among the teaching staff, and between students and teacher reflects the professional adequacy of an institution. Asttecs presents a competitively priced, highly feature-rich, IP PBX solution that creates an engaging experience for all the stakeholders, at every stage of the learning cycle,” Manjunath added.

Federighi showcased a special App Store for iMessage. This will let developers engage with iOS users and offer their apps through an app drawer right within the messaging app. Additionally, developers can list their stickers and personalised GIFs to enhance the existing messaging experience across iPhone and iPad models.

The developer community can leverage the power of iOS 10 to enable payments directly through iMessage. Likewise, users can book a table for lunch or schedule a movie using third-party iMessage apps.

Apart from the new changes in iMessage, Apple has upgraded its voice-based virtual assistant Siri. Third-party developers can now integrate the Siri API to advance their apps. Although the new development was initially limited to some payment, photo and VoIP apps, it will get expanded soon to take on similar offerings including Microsoft's Cortana, Google Now and Amazon's Alexa.

Unlike Google, Apple is infamous for its exclusivity. The company has a record of successfully maintaining closed source programs in the past. But as things are swiftly transforming in the tech world, the Tim Cook-led team is also opening new avenues.

To make things easier for young developers, Cook introduced the Swift Playgrounds app. This new app is apparently aimed at expanding Apple's Swift language that was launched as an open source platform last year.

Cook said that the new app offers “a new way to learn to code”. It comes with built-in templates and also challenges students to learn some core coding concepts right, using an iPad.

Apple has a vast catalogue of more than two million apps on its App Store, which was launched with merely 500 apps in July 2008. The new efforts are likely to enhance these stats by adding new apps. However, competition is still tough for the iPhone maker.



Companies like Google and Microsoft are in the race to woo developers to their platforms. Google already has its open source Android, while Microsoft is engaging the developer community with its Universal Windows Platform (UWP) initiative.

That being said, Apple is aiming to improve its market performance by utilising the changes from its latest WWDC.

You can experience the new developments by downloading iOS 10 beta version on your Apple device. It is compatible with all the iPhone models that were running on iOS 9, except the iPhone 4s.